

Employee Laptop Request Management System

Project Documentation

15. Flow Designer – Approval Automation

15.1 Objective

The objective of this automation is to manage the end-to-end approval and execution process for the Employee Laptop Request Form using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The flow automates the process from the moment a laptop request is submitted until the approval decision is recorded.

The automation provides:

Automatic triggering of the manager approval process.

Automatic status updates based on the approval outcome.

Email notifications at relevant stages.

Reduced manual intervention.

Consistent and traceable request processing.

15.2 Flow Trigger

The flow is configured to execute whenever a new Laptop Request record is created.

Configuration	Value
Trigger	Record Created
Table	Laptop Request Form
Table Name	u_laptop_request_form
Trigger Timing	When a new record is created

Trigger Condition

When: Record is Created

Table: Laptop Request Form

Trigger Purpose

The trigger automatically starts the approval process immediately after an employee submits a new laptop request.

15.3 Flow Overview

The complete flow consists of four major stages:

Laptop Request Created



Initialize Request



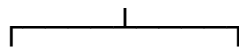
Set Default Status



Request Manager Approval



Approval Decision



Approved Rejected



Update Update

Status Status



Notify IT Notify User

15.4 Flow Subtasks

The Flow Designer implementation contains the following four major subtasks:

Initialize Request & Set Default Status

Manager Approval Request

Approval Decision Handling – If/Else

Optional IT Notification – Post Approval

16. Subtask 1 – Initialize Request & Set Default Status

Objective

Initialize the newly created laptop request and assign the initial request status.

Steps

The flow is triggered when a new Laptop Request Form record is created.

The request record is identified using the trigger data.

The initial status is set to:

Pending Approval

Logic

New Laptop Request

↓

Flow Trigger

↓

Set Status = Pending Approval

Outcome

Every newly submitted laptop request enters the approval process with a clearly defined initial status.

17. Subtask 2 – Manager Approval Request

Objective

Automatically send the laptop request to the appropriate manager for approval.

Steps

Retrieve the Manager associated with the laptop request.

Create an approval request for the manager.

Send the approval request through the ServiceNow approval mechanism.

Wait for the manager's decision.

Process

Laptop Request



Identify Manager



Create Approval



Send Approval Request



Wait for Decision

Outcome

The manager receives an approval request without requiring manual intervention from the IT team.

18. Subtask 3 – Approval Decision Handling

Objective

Process the manager's approval decision and update the laptop request accordingly.

An If / Else logic is used to evaluate the approval result.

Approval Decision

The flow checks whether the manager has:

Approved the request, or

Rejected the request.

18.1 If Approved

When the manager approves the request:

Update the request status to:

Approved

Continue the post-approval process.

Send the appropriate notification.

Flow

Manager Approval



Approved?



Yes



Status = Approved



Post-Approval Processing

18.2 If Rejected

When the manager rejects the request:

Update the request status to:

Rejected

Notify the requester of the rejection.

End the approval flow.

Flow

Manager Approval



Approved?



No



Status = Rejected



Notify Requester



End Flow

19. Subtask 4 – Optional IT Notification

Objective

Notify the IT team after the manager has approved the laptop request.

This step provides visibility to the IT team so that the approved request can proceed to fulfillment.

Steps

Check whether the manager has approved the request.

Send an email notification to the appropriate IT team or group.

Include relevant request information.

Example Notification Information

Request Number

Requester

Employee Email

Request Type

Manager

Approval Status

Request Reason

Process

Manager Approves Request



Status = Approved



IT Notification



IT Team Processes Request

20. Email Notification Flow

Email notifications can be configured at different stages of the request lifecycle.

Stage	Recipient	Purpose
Request Submitted	Requester / Manager	Inform that request was submitted
Approval Required	Manager	Request manager approval
Request Approved	Requester	Inform employee that request was approved
Request Rejected	Requester	Inform employee that request was rejected
Post Approval	IT Team	Inform IT team to process the approved request

21. Complete Flow Designer Process

The complete automation can be represented as:

RECORD CREATED

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Laptop Request Form



Initialize Request



Status = Pending

Approval



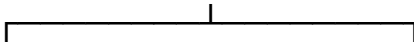
Identify Manager



Manager Approval



Wait for Decision



Approved



Rejected



Status = Approved Status = Rejected

|

|



Notify IT Team

Notify Employee

|

|



Fulfillment

End Flow

22. Automation Benefits

The Flow Designer implementation provides several benefits:

Automated Approval

Manager approval is automatically initiated when a laptop request is submitted.

Automatic Status Management

The request status changes according to the manager's decision.

Automated Notifications

Relevant users and teams can receive notifications at important stages.

Reduced Manual Work

The process does not require an IT administrator to manually initiate each approval.

Improved Visibility

The request status and approval decision are recorded directly against the request.

Auditability

The automated flow provides a consistent record of the request and approval lifecycle.

23. Flow Designer Components

Component

Purpose

Component	Purpose
Record Created Trigger	Starts the flow
Laptop Request Form	Source table
Update Record	Sets request status
Approval Action	Sends request to manager
Wait for Approval	Waits for decision
If / Else	Evaluates approval outcome
Send Email	Sends notifications
Update Request	Records final status

24. Final Outcome

The Flow Designer automation transforms the Laptop Request process into an automated approval workflow.

The complete lifecycle is:

Employee Submission → Request Creation → Pending Approval → Manager Approval → Approved/Rejected → Notification → IT Processing